

# Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 4

## Chapter 2: नित्यं पिबामः सुभाषितरसम् (Nityam Pibamah Subhashitarasam)

### Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

|                        |                                                                |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Subject</b>         | Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)                             |
| <b>Chapter</b>         | 2 — नित्यं पिबामः सुभाषितरसम् (Nityam Pibamah Subhashitarasam) |
| <b>Total Questions</b> | 60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)                           |
| <b>Maximum Marks</b>   | 240                                                            |
| <b>Suggested Time</b>  | 90 minutes                                                     |

**Marking scheme:** +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

**Instructions:** Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Classic Paper-4 traps: silently dropping or doubling an item to make the va-qualities six or the faults five; mismatching each purification part to the wrong means (esp. बुद्धिः→जलेन); confusing निद्रा/तन्द्रा and आलस्यम्/दीर्घसूत्रता as one fault; reading instrumental means-words as nominative subjects; and forcing one universal method onto goals that each demand their own means. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

- नित्यं पिबामः सुभाषितरसम् uses 'पिबामः' (we drink) for an act of the mind, not the throat. The verb-choice 'drink' rather than 'read' is meant to suggest that wise sayings should be:  
(A) swallowed once quickly and never returned to  
(B) consumed only when one is physically thirsty  
(C) tasted but spat out because their flavour is bitter  
(D) taken in regularly and absorbed as inner nourishment, the way a drink sustains the body
- In 'पिबामः', the ending '-आमः' identifies the verb as:  
(A) third person singular present — 'he drinks'  
(B) first person plural present — 'we drink'  
(C) second person plural imperative — 'you all drink!'  
(D) first person singular present — 'I drink'
- A pupil writes the plural of सुभाषितम् as 'सुभाषिताः', reasoning that नराः is the plural of नरः so the same '-आः' must apply. The precise flaw is that:

- (A) नरः is masculine and takes '-आः', but सुभाषितम् is neuter and its nominative plural is सुभाषितानि ('-आनि')
- (B) सुभाषितम् is feminine, so its plural is सुभाषिताः after all
- (C) all -अ-stem nouns take '-आः' regardless of gender, so the pupil is right
- (D) सुभाषितम् has no plural because abstract sayings cannot be counted

4. The title-word सुभाषितरसम् packs three pieces: सु + भाषित + रस. Read as a whole, its structure is best described as:

- (A) 'the rasa OF the well-spoken (saying)' — सुभाषित (well-spoken saying) qualifies रस in a genitive (tatpurusha) relation
- (B) 'a rasa that is both bad and spoken' — सु here means 'bad'
- (C) 'rasa AND a saying' — two equal, unrelated nouns joined as a pair
- (D) 'O sweet saying!' — a word used purely to address the verses

5. नरः पञ्चभिः वकारैः पूजितः. A reader who renders this as 'the man worships by five va-things' has misread the grammar because पूजितः is:

- (A) an active present verb meaning 'he worships', so the man is the worshipper
- (B) an imperative, ordering the man to worship the five things
- (C) a past passive participle — the man is the one BEING honoured, not the one doing the honouring
- (D) a future tense, predicting that the man will worship later

6. Exactly five qualities honour a person and exactly six faults are to be shed. A student lists honouring qualities as विद्या, वपुस्, वाणी, वस्त्र, विनय, सत्य. The single defect is:

- (A) सत्य is not one of the five 'va' qualities — it is a purification MEANS (मनः सत्येन शुध्यति); the five are विद्या, वपुस्, वाणी, वस्त्र, विनय
- (B) nothing is wrong; there are six 'va' qualities
- (C) वस्त्र should be removed, leaving only four genuine qualities
- (D) विनय is the intruder; the real fifth quality is सत्य

7. The pot fills 'जलबिन्दुनिपातेन क्रमशः' (drop by falling drop, gradually). Transferred to character-building, the deepest implication is that one small undesirable act, repeated, also:

- (A) has no effect at all, since only large single acts change anything
- (B) accumulates gradually into a large result, so habits (good or bad) build the same drop-by-drop way
- (C) instantly creates a finished character with no further effort
- (D) can be cancelled because drops never really add up

8. षड्दोषाः splits into षड् + दोषाः. The first member षड् here means:

- (A) 'well/good', the same सु that begins सुभाषित
- (B) 'to be abandoned', the meaning carried by हातव्याः
- (C) 'long', the दीर्घ that begins दीर्घसूत्रता
- (D) 'six' — षड्दोषाः = 'the six faults'

9. नित्यम् + पिबामः joins to नित्यं पिबामः. The change of final म् to the anusvāra ँ before प is an instance of:

- (A) vowel-lengthening, because two vowels met and merged into one long vowel
- (B) visarga sandhi, where a final ः changed to ँ
- (C) consonant-doubling, where प was repeated to make प्प
- (D) the rule that word-final म् becomes anusvāra (ँ) before a following consonant

10. विद्यया, वपुषा, वाचा, वस्त्रेण, विनयेन are the five qualities as they appear in the verse. Why are these the forms used rather than the dictionary forms विद्या, वपुस्, etc.?

- (A) because they are the subjects performing the honouring, hence nominative
- (B) because the qualities are being directly addressed, hence vocative
- (C) because the verse says one is honoured BY them — the means of honouring takes the instrumental (तृतीया)
- (D) because they show whose qualities they are, hence genitive

11. The purification verse pairs four parts with four means. A boy claims 'water purifies everything — body, mind, soul and intellect alike.' His error, by the verse, is that:

- (A) water purifies nothing in the verse; knowledge does all four
- (B) the verse pairs all four parts with truth, not water
- (C) each part has its own distinct means — water for the body, truth for the mind, austerity for the soul, knowledge for the intellect — so water alone purifies only the body
- (D) the verse leaves the means unspecified, so any choice including water is acceptable

12. By the purification verse, which single change to this set of claims would make ALL four correct?

'गात्राणि जलेन; मनः ज्ञानेन; आत्मा तपसा; बुद्धिः सत्येन.'

- (A) swap the means of गात्राणि and आत्मा, giving गात्राणि तपसा and आत्मा जलेन
- (B) change गात्राणि जलेन to गात्राणि सत्येन
- (C) swap the means of मनः and बुद्धिः, giving मनः सत्येन and बुद्धिः ज्ञानेन
- (D) leave it unchanged; the set is already fully correct

13. बुद्धिः केन शुध्यति? A learner answers जलेन because 'water cleans, so it must clean the intellect too.' The flaw in this reasoning is that it:

- (A) is correct — water does clean the intellect in the verse
- (B) wrongly assumes the intellect needs cleaning at all
- (C) should have answered तपसा, the means for the intellect
- (D) over-generalises water's role: water cleans the physical body (गात्राणि), but the intellect is cleaned by knowledge (ज्ञानेन)

14. षड् दोषाः हातव्याः भूतिम् इच्छता. The reason 'भूतिम् इच्छता' is instrumental rather than nominative भूतिम् इच्छन् is that:

- (A) इच्छता is the direct object of the faults and objects take the instrumental
- (B) instrumental here means 'O desirer of prosperity!', a form of address
- (C) the phrase means prosperity is desired BY the six faults
- (D) the gerundive हतव्या: ('to-be-abandoned') puts its agent — the one who must do the abandoning — in the instrumental

**15.** A reader counts the faults as 'निद्रा/तन्द्रा = one sleepy fault; आलस्यम्/दीर्घसूत्रता = one lazy fault; भयम्; क्रोधः', concluding there are FOUR faults. The correct rebuttal is:

- (A) the reader is right; there really are only four faults
- (B) there are five faults, because भयम् and क्रोधः are also one fault
- (C) there are eight faults once each pair is split into three
- (D) the verse names six DISTINCT faults: निद्रा≠तन्द्रा (full sleep vs drowsy half-sleep) and आलस्यम्≠दीर्घसूत्रता (general laziness vs delaying tasks), so merging undercounts to four

**16.** Which contrast correctly separates the two faults most often confused — one being a settled state of doing nothing, the other a pattern of putting off particular tasks?

- (A) निद्रा = doing nothing; तन्द्रा = delaying tasks
- (B) आलस्यम् = general laziness (doing nothing); दीर्घसूत्रता = procrastination (delaying specific tasks)
- (C) क्रोधः = doing nothing; भयम् = delaying tasks
- (D) दीर्घसूत्रता = doing nothing; आलस्यम् = delaying tasks (the reverse)

**17.** तन्द्रा and निद्रा are listed as two separate faults. The finest distinction the chapter draws is:

- (A) निद्रा is drowsiness while तन्द्रा is deep sleep (the reverse)
- (B) निद्रा is full sleep; तन्द्रा is drowsiness — a sluggish, half-awake state
- (C) both mean anger, distinguished only by intensity
- (D) निद्रा means fear and तन्द्रा means procrastination

**18.** आलस्यम् + हि joins to आलस्यं हि (in आलस्यं हि मनुष्याणाम्...). The shift of final म् to anusvāra ँ before ह is governed by:

- (A) visarga sandhi turning a ः into anusvāra
- (B) the rule that word-final म् becomes anusvāra (ँ) before a following consonant such as ह
- (C) vowel sandhi merging अ + इ into a long vowel
- (D) the rule that ह always doubles the preceding nasal

**19.** आलस्यं हि मनुष्याणां शरीरस्थो महान् रिपुः. The case and number of मनुष्याणाम् and what it answers are:

- (A) instrumental plural ('by men') — answering 'by whom?'
- (B) accusative plural ('the men') — naming the object struck
- (C) genitive plural ('of men') — answering 'an enemy OF WHOM?'
- (D) dative singular ('for a man') — naming the beneficiary

**20.** In आलस्यं ... महान् रिपुः, the words आलस्यम् and रिपुः are both nominative. Their grammatical relationship is:

- (A) आलस्यम् is the object that रिपुः acts upon
- (B) रिपुः is the means by which laziness operates
- (C) predicate identification — 'laziness IS a great enemy' — subject and predicate noun agreeing in the nominative
- (D) रिपुः possesses laziness, in a genitive-like sense

**21.** गात्राणि जलेन शुध्यन्ति uses शुध्यन्ति (plural), but बुद्धिः ... शुध्यति uses शुध्यति (singular). The reason for the different verb-endings is:

- (A) verb-number agrees with the subject: गात्राणि (limbs) is plural so the verb is plural, while बुद्धिः (intellect) is singular so the verb is singular
- (B) the tense changes — शुध्यन्ति is past and शुध्यति is present
- (C) गात्राणि is a command form while बुद्धिः is a statement
- (D) the means differ — जलेन forces a plural verb, ज्ञानेन forces a singular verb

**22.** शरीरस्थः ('seated in the body') is applied to laziness as रिपुः. Calling laziness an INNER enemy carries the deeper lesson that:

- (A) external enemies are far more dangerous than one's own habits
- (B) the body itself is the enemy and should be neglected or harmed
- (C) the chief obstacle to achievement lies within oneself, so one must conquer one's own tendency rather than blame outside foes
- (D) an inner enemy can never be defeated, so striving is pointless

**23.** Two pupils prepare for one exam. Riya studies 25 minutes every single day; Dev does nothing for weeks, then studies 12 hours the night before. Mapped onto the chapter's two key verses, the BEST description is:

- (A) Dev embodies the drop-pot verse, since one big effort fills the pot fastest
- (B) Riya embodies जलबिन्दुनिपातेन (steady drop-by-drop accumulation); Dev's last-night cramming reflects दीर्घसूत्रता (procrastination)
- (C) both equally embody क्रमशः, since only total study time matters
- (D) Riya embodies आलस्यम् and Dev embodies विद्या

**24.** The chapter's two great verses are (i) drop-fills-pot and (ii) each part purified by its own means. Read together, their single combined message is:

- (A) any random method works if you simply wait long enough
- (B) worthwhile results come from steady, repeated effort applied through the right means for each goal
- (C) speed of a single burst matters more than choosing the right method
- (D) outcomes are fixed in advance, so neither effort nor method changes them

**25.** The drop-and-pot image is extended in the verse to three things that grow the same gradual way. The metaphor implies that these three are NOT:

- (A) worth acquiring at all, since slow growth means low value
- (B) the six faults, which alone grow gradually
- (C) acquired instantly or by a single grand effort — विद्या, धर्म and धनम् all accumulate little by little
- (D) physical objects like the pot and the drops themselves

**26.** Calling subhashitas 'रस' (nectar) one DRINKS, while calling laziness a 'रिपुः' (enemy) one must conquer, sets up a deliberate contrast. The shared lesson of both metaphors is that:

- (A) the path to growth means actively taking in what nourishes (wisdom) and actively fighting what harms (laziness) — both require ongoing effort
- (B) both wisdom and laziness should simply be left alone
- (C) nectar should be avoided and the enemy should be welcomed
- (D) wisdom and laziness are really the same inner force

**27.** जलबिन्दुनिपातेन splits as जल + बिन्दु + निपात + (instrumental -एन). Read whole, it means:

- (A) 'by water and a separate drop and a fall' — three unrelated instruments
- (B) 'for the sake of a water-drop's fall' — a purpose, not a means
- (C) 'by the falling of water-drops' — the means by which the pot fills
- (D) 'in the place where water-drops fall' — a location

**28.** जलबिन्दुनिपातेन ... पूर्यते घटः. The verb पूर्यते is passive. What does the passive voice make clear about घटः?

- (A) घटः is the thing BEING filled (the patient); the falling drops (instrumental) are the means doing the filling
- (B) घटः is actively filling something else
- (C) the drops are being filled by the pot
- (D) no filling occurs — it is merely a question

**29.** A child surrounds herself with friends who all skip work and put things off, and within weeks she does the same. Combining two chapter-ideas, this is best explained as:

- (A) good सङ्गतिः strengthening her विद्या
- (B) poor सङ्गतिः (bad company) breeding the fault of दीर्घसूत्रता in her
- (C) the harmless result of company, which has no effect on character
- (D) her practice of विनय (humility) toward her friends

**30.** रिपुः ('enemy') names something to be conquered. Which chapter-word is its closest functional OPPOSITE — something one should keep CLOSE because it helps the person?

- (A) दीर्घसूत्रता (procrastination), a habit to keep close
- (B) सङ्गतिः (good company), which the chapter says shapes character for the better
- (C) निद्रा (sleep), a friend to indulge
- (D) क्रोधः (anger), an ally to nurture

**31.** A coach drives a lazy student to train hard, and the student improves. Mapping प्रेरकः (inspirer) and रिपुः (enemy) onto this, the correct fit is:

(A) the coach is the रिपुः and the student's laziness is the प्रेरकः

(B) both the coach and the laziness are प्रेरकाः (C) both the coach and the laziness are रिपवः

(D) the coach is the प्रेरकः (the one who impels forward); the student's own laziness is the inner रिपुः he overcomes

**32.** प्रेरकः is built from a root meaning 'to impel/drive forward' plus an agent-suffix. By this formation प्रेरकः means:

(A) 'the act of being inspired' — inspiration as an abstract event

(B) 'one who is impelled' — the follower who receives the push

(C) 'the place where inspiration happens'

(D) 'one who impels or inspires' — an inspirer (the doer)

**33.** दीर्घसूत्रता and दीर्घायुष् both begin with दीर्घ ('long'), yet diverge completely in meaning. The pair is:

(A) दीर्घसूत्रता = long life; दीर्घायुष् = procrastination (the reverse)

(B) both mean 'a long thread' literally

(C) दीर्घसूत्रता = procrastination ('long-thread-ness', dragging tasks out); दीर्घायुष् = long-lived / a long lifespan

(D) both mean 'a long life' and are interchangeable

**34.** The दीर्घसूत्रता vs दीर्घायुष् contrast teaches a general principle about reading Sanskrit compounds. That principle is:

(A) the same first member can yield very different meanings, so one must read the WHOLE compound, including the second member

(B) the first member alone always fixes the compound's meaning

(C) compounds sharing a first word always mean the same thing

(D) the second member never affects the overall meaning

**35.** दीर्घायुष् appears alongside the faults yet is NOT one of the six. It is best classified as:

(A) a blessing / virtue — a long lifespan — and not a fault at all

(B) the sixth fault, replacing दीर्घसूत्रता (C) another name for आलस्यम् (laziness)

(D) the name of the pot in the drop-and-pot verse

**36.** If the verse changed to 'a man is honoured by SIX va-qualities', the number-word पञ्चभिः would become:

(A) it would stay पञ्चभिः, since the form is fixed (B) षष्ठीभिः, a genitive plural form

(C) षट्सु, a locative form

(D) षड्भिः — the instrumental plural of षष् ('six')

**37.** विद्यया and वस्त्रेण both honour a person, yet their endings differ (-या vs -ेण). The correct explanation is:

(A) they are in different cases — one instrumental, one genitive

(B) the different endings mean one is singular and the other plural

- (C) they come from different stem-classes (feminine आ-stem विद्या vs neuter अ-stem वस्त्र) but both realise the SAME instrumental ('by/with') meaning
- (D) विद्यया is a verb form while वस्त्रेण is a noun

**38.** Using the verse's pattern (विनय = humility, instrumental विनयेन), build the phrase 'a man is honoured by humility':

- (A) नरः विनयः पूजितः ('humility is honoured') (B) नरः विनयेन पूजितः
- (C) नरः विनयाय पूजितः ('honoured for/towards humility')
- (D) नरः विनयस्य पूजितः ('of humility, honoured')

**39.** Form the correct phrase for 'the soul is purified by austerity' on the verse's own pattern (तपस् = austerity, आत्मा = soul):

- (A) आत्मा जलेन शुध्यति ('purified by water')
- (B) आत्मा तपसा शुध्यति ('the soul is purified by austerity')
- (C) आत्मा ज्ञानेन शुध्यति ('purified by knowledge') (D) आत्मा तपः शुध्यति ('austerity is purified')

**40.** In शुध्यति केन? ('by what does it become pure?'), the question-word केन is itself instrumental. This tells us the expected ANSWER must be:

- (A) a nominative subject such as बुद्धिः (B) a genitive such as मनुष्याणाम्
- (C) a vocative such as हे बुद्धे
- (D) another instrumental naming a means — e.g. जलेन, सत्येन, तपसा, or ज्ञानेन

**41.** Match each question-word to the case it expects in its answer. Which pairing is CORRECT?

- (A) केन ('by what') → nominative answer such as बुद्धिः
- (B) केषाम् ('of whom') → instrumental answer such as मनुष्यैः
- (C) कस्मै ('for whom') → genitive answer such as मनुष्यस्य
- (D) कतिभिः ('by how many') → instrumental plural answer such as पञ्चभिः

**42.** नरः पञ्चभिः वकारैः पूजितः — नरः is nominative. Why?

- (A) नरः is the means by which the honouring is done
- (B) नरः is the recipient to whom honour is given
- (C) नरः is being directly addressed as 'O man!'
- (D) नरः is the subject about which the predicate पूजितः ('honoured') is asserted

**43.** A student honours a classmate only for his expensive clothes, ignoring his rudeness and idleness. Judged by the five 'va' qualities, this honouring is:

- (A) only partly grounded — वस्त्र (dress) is one of the five, but विद्या, वाणी and विनय are also required for full honour
- (B) fully justified, since वस्त्र alone is the only quality that earns honour
- (C) entirely wrong, because वस्त्र (dress) is not among the five qualities
- (D) based on a fault, since वस्त्र is one of the six दोषाः



**44.** वाणी (speech) is praised as a 'va' quality, yet क्रोधः (anger) is condemned as a fault. A pupil who speaks harshly in anger is failing the chapter because:

- (A) good speech (वाणी) is a virtue, but yielding to anger (क्रोधः) corrupts that very speech — so he loses the virtue by indulging the fault
- (B) speech is always a fault, so वाणी is wrongly listed
- (C) anger is a virtue when expressed through speech
- (D) वाणी and क्रोधः mean the same thing

**45.** The qualities are honoured 'by' them and the faults are 'to be given up by one who desires prosperity'. Synthesising both verses, the chapter's combined recipe for a respected, prosperous life is:

- (A) gather wealth alone and sleep more
- (B) cultivate qualities OR shed faults, but never attempt both
- (C) cultivate the five 'va' qualities to earn respect AND shed the six faults to gain prosperity
- (D) feared by all through anger, and idle through procrastination

**46.** A teacher says: 'A pot fills drop by drop, but a single lie ruins purity at once.' Which chapter-verse pair does she correctly weave together?

- (A) the five va-qualities verse and the six-faults verse
- (B) the drop-and-pot verse (gradual gain) and the purification verse (the mind needs truth, सत्येन — so a lie defiles it)
- (C) the title verse and the inner-enemy verse only
- (D) the drop-and-pot verse and the दीर्घायुष् blessing

**47.** नरः is honoured BY qualities (instrumental), but the faults are TO BE GIVEN UP (gerundive). A learner says 'both constructions put the key noun in the same case.' This is:

- (A) true — every key noun in both verses is instrumental
- (B) false — the honouring qualities are instrumental (the means), while the agent who gives up faults is also instrumental, but the subject नरः is nominative and the faults दोषाः are nominative; the constructions are not uniform
- (C) true — every key noun in both verses is nominative
- (D) false, because the faults verse uses no nouns at all

**48.** Which one item is the ODD ONE OUT because it is NOT a purification MEANS in the verse?

- (A) विद्या (knowledge) — the means is ज्ञानेन; विद्या is instead one of the five honouring qualities
- (B) जलम् (water)
- (C) सत्यम् (truth)
- (D) तपस् (austerity)

**49.** Which item is the ODD ONE OUT because it is NOT one of the six faults?

- (A) तन्द्रा (drowsiness) (B) भयम् (fear)  
(C) वाणी (speech) — it is one of the five honouring qualities, not a fault  
(D) दीर्घसूत्रता (procrastination)

**50.** A friend argues 'विद्या is listed both as a honouring quality and as a purification means, so the two verses overlap on it.' The accurate correction is:

- (A) correct — विद्या appears in both verses identically  
(B) correct — विद्या cleans the body and also honours the person  
(C) no — विद्या (knowledge) honours a person, while the purification means for the intellect is ज्ञानेन; the verses do not actually share विद्या  
(D) no — विद्या appears in neither verse at all

**51.** A student insists 'क्रमशः means the pot fills suddenly once it is nearly full.' Using the verse's logic, the precise correction is:

- (A) क्रमशः means 'gradually, step by step' throughout — the whole filling is incremental, not a sudden final jump  
(B) correct — क्रमशः marks the sudden last-moment filling  
(C) क्रमशः means 'all at once', so the pot fills instantly  
(D) क्रमशः means 'backwards', so the pot empties

**52.** Mapping the drop-pot verse onto a moral choice: a child tells one small lie each day, thinking 'one tiny lie cannot matter.' The verse's principle exposes the flaw as:

- (A) correct — a single small lie truly never accumulates into anything  
(B) the verse only concerns water, so it says nothing about lying  
(C) the lies will cancel themselves out over time  
(D) small repeated acts accumulate like drops into a full pot, so daily small lies build into a large habit of dishonesty

**53.** A pupil summarises the chapter: 'There are six honouring qualities, the mind is purified by water, and दीर्घसूत्रता means long life.' How many distinct errors are present?

- (A) one — only the count of qualities is wrong  
(B) three — the honouring qualities are FIVE (not six), the mind is purified by TRUTH (not water), and दीर्घसूत्रता means PROCRASTINATION (not long life)  
(C) two — the count and the दीर्घसूत्रता meaning, but 'mind by water' is fine  
(D) zero — the summary is entirely correct

**54.** Which single statement is FULLY correct on every count?

- (A) There are five honouring 'va' qualities and six faults; the intellect is purified by knowledge (ज्ञानेन) and the body by water (जलेन).  
(B) There are six 'va' qualities and five faults; the intellect is purified by water.

(C) There are five 'va' qualities and six faults; the intellect is purified by water and the body by knowledge.

(D) There are five 'va' qualities and six faults; but the mind is purified by austerity and the soul by truth.

**55.** The chapter title नित्यम् पिबामः सुभाषितरसम्, taken as a guide to living, most precisely advises:

(A) read one wise saying once in a lifetime and then stop

(B) make absorbing wise sayings a DAILY habit, so their wisdom accumulates over time like drops filling a pot

(C) literally drink water every day to clean the intellect

(D) memorise sayings only on the night before an examination

**56.** Suppose a person has all five honouring qualities but still harbours क्रोधः and दीर्घसूत्रता. By the chapter's combined teaching, the most accurate verdict is:

(A) he is fully complete, since possessing the five qualities cancels any faults

(B) he deserves no respect at all, because keeping two faults erases all his qualities

(C) the faults are irrelevant, since only the five qualities determine one's life

(D) he earns respect for his qualities but still risks losing prosperity, because the faults he keeps must be shed by one who desires भूति

**57.** A learner reasons: 'Since वपुस् (a good body) is a honouring quality, sleeping a lot to keep the body rested must also be a virtue.' The chapter refutes this because:

(A) a healthy body (वपुस्) is a virtue, but yielding to निद्रा/तन्द्रा (sleep/drowsiness) is a fault — the point is mastery over the body, not indulging it

(B) the body is always a fault, so वपुस् is wrongly listed as a quality

(C) sleep is indeed a virtue whenever it rests the body

(D) वपुस् and निद्रा are the same thing, so both are virtues

**58.** Pulling the whole chapter together, which one-line statement best captures its unified philosophy of self-improvement?

(A) earn respect through good qualities, shed inner faults, and pursue every goal with steady daily effort using the right means for it

(B) seek instant results through a single all-purpose method and good luck

(C) depend entirely on outside helpers, since the obstacles are all external

(D) value sleep, comfort and delay, since effort rarely changes outcomes

**59.** हातव्याः (in षड् दोषाः हातव्याः) is a gerundive ('to-be-done') form. Which paraphrase preserves its force MOST exactly?

(A) 'were given up long ago' — a completed past act

(B) 'are being given up right now' — an action in progress

(C) 'ought to be / must be given up' — an obligation still to be carried out

(D) 'will be praised in the future' — a coming reward

**60.** सुभाषितरसम् in the title carries the accusative -अम् ending because, in नित्यं पिबामः सुभाषितरसम्, it is:

- (A) the subject doing the drinking, hence nominative
- (B) the means by which we drink, hence instrumental
- (C) the person addressed, hence vocative
- (D) the direct object of पिबामः — the 'nectar' that is drunk

# Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 2: नित्यं पिबामः सुभाषितरसम् (Nityam Pibamah Subhashitarasam) — Paper 4

## Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

## Answer Key

| Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans | Q  | Ans |
|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|-----|
| 1  | D   | 11 | C   | 21 | A   | 31 | D   | 41 | D   | 51 | A   |
| 2  | B   | 12 | C   | 22 | C   | 32 | D   | 42 | D   | 52 | D   |
| 3  | A   | 13 | D   | 23 | B   | 33 | C   | 43 | A   | 53 | B   |
| 4  | A   | 14 | D   | 24 | B   | 34 | A   | 44 | A   | 54 | A   |
| 5  | C   | 15 | D   | 25 | C   | 35 | A   | 45 | C   | 55 | B   |
| 6  | A   | 16 | B   | 26 | A   | 36 | D   | 46 | B   | 56 | D   |
| 7  | B   | 17 | B   | 27 | C   | 37 | C   | 47 | B   | 57 | A   |
| 8  | D   | 18 | B   | 28 | A   | 38 | B   | 48 | A   | 58 | A   |
| 9  | D   | 19 | C   | 29 | B   | 39 | B   | 49 | C   | 59 | C   |
| 10 | C   | 20 | C   | 30 | B   | 40 | D   | 50 | C   | 60 | D   |

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

## Worked Solutions

**1. (D)** The metaphor of drinking rasa daily frames subhashitas as a sustaining, repeated nourishment of the mind. Treating them as a one-time gulp ignores 'नित्यम्' (daily). Tying 'drink' to bodily thirst literalises a deliberately figurative verb. Calling the flavour bitter inverts 'rasa' (nectar/sweet essence).

**2. (B)** The '-आमः' ending marks उत्तमपुरुष बहुवचन (first person plural) present, hence 'we drink', matching the inclusive 'we' of the title. A third-person 'he drinks' would end '-ति'. An imperative 'drink!' would use a command ending, not the simple present. A first-person singular 'I drink' would end '-आमि'.

**3. (A)** Gender governs the plural ending: masculine अ-STEMS (नरः) take -आः, but neuter अ-STEMS take -आनि, giving सुभाषितानि. Calling सुभाषितम् feminine is wrong (it is neuter). The ending is not gender-blind. Sayings are perfectly countable — सुभाषितानि is a standard plural.

**4. (A)** सु ('well/good') + भाषित ('spoken') = सुभाषित ('well-spoken saying'), and सुभाषितरस is 'the nectar of such sayings' — a tatpuruṣa where the first member relates to रस like a genitive. सु never means 'bad' (that would be दुः). It is not a coordinate pair (the two members are not equals). It is not a form of address.

**5. (C)** पूजितः ('honoured') is a -त past passive participle: नरः is the patient who is honoured BY (instrumental पञ्चभिः वक्रैः) the five qualities. Reading it as an active 'he worships' reverses subject and means. It is not a command, nor a future prediction — the form is a completed/stative passive participle.

**6. (A)** सत्य belongs to the purification verse (it cleans the mind), not the honouring list, which has exactly five व-words. There are five, not six, honouring qualities. वस्त्र is genuinely one of the five. विनय is genuine; सत्य is the smuggled-in intruder.

**7. (B)** The drop-pot principle is that small repeated inputs accumulate into something large — which applies symmetrically to good and bad habits. Saying small acts have no effect denies the very gradualism the verse teaches. The verse explicitly rejects 'instant' results ('क्रमशः'). And drops manifestly DO add up — that is the whole image.

**8. (D)** षड् is the combining form of षष् ('six'), so षड्दोषाः names the six faults. सु ('well') begins a different word (सुभाषित). The 'to-be-abandoned' sense lives in हातव्याः, not in षड्. दीर्घ ('long') is the opening of दीर्घसूत्रता, unrelated to षड्.

**9. (D)** Final म् regularly becomes anusvāra before a consonant, giving नित्यं पिबामः. No two vowels met here, so it is not vowel sandhi. There is no visarga (ः) involved. Nor is any consonant doubled — प stays single.

**10. (C)** 'Honoured by knowledge/body/...' makes each quality the instrument of honour, so each appears in the instrumental case. They are not the doers (नरः, nominative, is the one honoured). They are not addressed. And they do not express possession ('of'), which would be genitive.

**11. (C)** The verse assigns गात्राणि-जलेन, मनः-सत्येन, आत्मा-तपसा, बुद्धिः-ज्ञानेन; water cleans only the body. Knowledge cleans the intellect alone, not all four. The mind is paired with truth, not all four with truth. The means are explicitly specified, so 'any choice' is wrong.

**12. (C)** गात्राणि-जलेन and आत्मा-तपसा are already right; only मनः and बुद्धिः have their means crossed, so swapping them (मनः सत्येन, बुद्धिः ज्ञानेन) fixes everything. Swapping the body/soul pair breaks the two correct rows. Body is cleaned by water, not truth. The set as given has two errors, so it is not already correct.

**13. (D)** Water's purifying role in the verse is limited to the body; the intellect's means is knowledge (ज्ञानेन). So water for the intellect is the trap. The verse does say the intellect is purified (बुद्धिः ज्ञानेन शुध्यति), so it does need a means. तपसा cleans the soul, not the intellect.

**14. (D)** With a gerundive ('the faults are to-be-given-up'), the agent who must perform the action stands in the instrumental — 'by one desiring prosperity'. Objects do not 'take the instrumental' as a rule. It is not a vocative address. And it is the person, not the faults, who desires prosperity.

**15. (D)** Each of the six is a separate fault; the apparent pairs are genuinely different shades (sleep vs drowsiness; laziness vs procrastination), so merging wrongly reduces six to four. The total is six, not four. भयम् and क्रोधः are distinct (fear vs anger), not one. And the count is six, not eight.

**16. (B)** आलस्यम् is broad inactivity, while दीर्घसूत्रता (literally 'long-thread-ness') is dragging out particular tasks. निद्रा/तन्द्रा are about sleep, not the laziness/delay split. भयम्/क्रोधः are fear and anger, unrelated to this contrast. The last option reverses the two correct meanings.

**17. (B)** निद्रा is actual sleep; तन्द्रा is the drowsy, half-asleep sluggishness that precedes or mimics it — distinct enough to be counted separately. The reverse mapping is wrong. Neither means anger. And neither means fear or procrastination — those are भयम् and दीर्घसूत्रता.

**18. (B)** Like नित्यं पिबामः, final म् becomes anusvāra before the consonant ह, giving आलस्यं हि. No visarga is present. No two vowels combine here. And ह does not trigger any nasal-doubling rule.

**19. (C)** मनुष्याणाम् is the षष्ठी (genitive) plural, telling whose enemy laziness is — 'the enemy of men'. An instrumental ('by men') would answer 'by whom', not 'of whom'. It is not an object (accusative). And it is plural ('men'), not a dative singular 'for a man'.

**20. (C)** Two nominatives joined by an implied 'is' form a subject–predicate-noun identity: 'laziness is an enemy'. Neither is the object of the other (no accusative). रिपुः is not an instrument (it would be instrumental). And there is no possession here — both share the nominative.

**21. (A)** A verb matches its subject in number: plural गात्राणि → शुध्यन्ति, singular बुद्धिः → शुध्यति. Both verbs are present, not different tenses. Neither is a command (no imperative ending). The means (जलेन/ज्ञानेन) is instrumental and does not control verb number — the subject does.

**22. (C)** Placing the enemy 'in the body' relocates the real obstacle inward — the fight is with one's own laziness. It does not say outside foes are worse. It blames laziness, not the body itself. And naming it an enemy implies it CAN and should be conquered, not that effort is futile.

**23. (B)** Daily small effort is exactly the drop-filling-pot image; postponing until the last night is the fault of दीर्घसूत्रता. A single late marathon is the opposite of 'क्रमशः'. The verse

prizes gradual accumulation, not raw total hours. And Riya is diligent (not lazy) while Dev's cramming is no virtue like विद्या.

**24. (B)** One verse supplies 'steady effort', the other 'the right means for each goal'; together they teach effort + appropriate method. 'Any method, just wait' drops the right-means lesson. 'Speed over method' contradicts both gradualism and the means-matching. And both verses assume effort changes outcomes, refuting fatalism.

**25. (C)** Extending the drop image to knowledge, virtue and wealth stresses that they accrue gradually, not in one stroke. Slow growth does not mean low value — the verse praises them. The trio is virtues/goods, not the faults. And they are abstract goods, not the literal pot and drops of the base image.

**26. (A)** One metaphor urges absorbing the good, the other urges defeating the bad — together a call to active, sustained engagement on both fronts. Leaving both alone ignores both verbs ('drink', 'conquer'). Welcoming the enemy and shunning the nectar inverts both. And wisdom (helpful) and laziness (harmful) are opposites, not the same force.

**27. (C)** The compound stacks जल-बिन्दु ('water-drop') with निपात ('falling') and the instrumental ending gives 'by the falling of water-drops' — the means filling the pot. It is one fused means, not three separate ones. The instrumental marks means, not purpose ('for the sake of'). And it is not a locative 'in the place'.

**28. (A)** Passive पूर्यते makes the pot the patient that gets filled, while the instrumental drops are the means. It is not the pot doing the filling (that would be active). The relation is not reversed — drops fill the pot, not vice versa. And it is a statement of filling, not a question.

**29. (B)** The chapter teaches that company shapes character; bad company here grows the procrastination fault. The company is harmful, not good, and the outcome is a fault, not knowledge. It contradicts the claim that company has no effect. And copying friends' delay is not humility (विनय).

**30. (B)** Good company is the beneficial influence to keep near, contrasting the inner enemy to be fought. Procrastination is itself a fault to shed, not a friend. Sleep (निद्रा) is one of the six faults, not something to indulge. Anger (क्रोधः) is likewise a fault, not an ally.

**31. (D)** The motivating coach matches प्रेरकः, while the laziness conquered within matches the inner रिपुः. Calling the helpful coach an enemy and the harmful laziness an inspirer reverses both. The laziness is not an inspirer. And the supportive coach is not an enemy, so they are not both रिपवः.

**32. (D)** The agent-suffix makes प्रेरकः the doer — 'one who impels', i.e. an inspirer. It does not name the abstract act of inspiration. Nor the passive recipient who is pushed. Nor a location — the word denotes an agent, not a place.



**33. (C)** दीर्घसूत्रता is the fault of stretching tasks out (procrastination); दीर्घायुष् is the blessing of a long life. The reverse mapping is wrong. Only the first is literally 'long-thread-ness'; दीर्घायुष् concerns lifespan. And the two are NOT interchangeable — one is a fault, the other a blessing.

**34. (A)** Because दीर्घ produces both 'procrastination' and 'long life', the meaning hinges on the second member — read the whole word. The first member alone clearly does not fix it (else they would match). Sharing दीर्घ did NOT make them mean the same. And here the second member is precisely what distinguishes them.

**35. (A)** दीर्घायुष् denotes a long life, a desirable thing, so it is not among the faults to shed. The sixth fault is दीर्घसूत्रता, not दीर्घायुष्. It is not a synonym for laziness. And it has nothing to do with the घटः of the drop verse.

**36. (D)** Keeping the instrumental 'by' but changing 'five' to 'six' gives षड्भिः (instrumental of षष्). It cannot stay पञ्चभिः, which means 'by five'. षष्ठीभिः is not the needed instrumental ('by'). षट्सु is locative ('in six'), not 'by six'.

**37. (C)** Both are instrumental singular; the endings differ only because the stems belong to different declensions, not because the case differs. They are the SAME case, not two cases. Both are singular — the ending difference is class, not number. And विद्यया is a noun, not a verb.

**38. (B)** 'By humility' is the instrumental विनयेन, matching विद्यया/वस्त्रेण. The nominative विनयः would make humility the subject, not the means. विनयाय is dative ('for'), not 'by'. विनयस्य is genitive ('of'), not the means.

**39. (B)** The verse pairs the soul with austerity in the instrumental: आत्मा तपसा शुध्यति. Water cleans the body, not the soul. Knowledge cleans the intellect, not the soul. And तपः is nominative ('austerity is purified'), reversing the intended means relation.

**40. (D)** An instrumental question ('by what?') is answered by an instrumental means-word like जलेन/ज्ञानेन. A nominative subject answers 'who/what acts?', not 'by what?'. A genitive answers 'of whom?'. A vocative is a form of address, not an answer to 'by what?'.

**41. (D)** 'By how many' (instrumental) is answered by an instrumental plural like पञ्चभिः. 'By what' expects an instrumental means (e.g. ज्ञानेन), not a nominative. 'Of whom' expects a genitive (मनुष्याणाम्), not an instrumental. 'For whom' expects a dative, not a genitive.

**42. (D)** नरः is the subject that is honoured, so it takes the nominative agreeing with पूजितः. The means is पञ्चभिः वकारैः (instrumental), not नरः. It is not a dative recipient. And it is not a vocative address (which would mark a call, not a subject).

**43. (A)** Dress is genuinely one honouring quality, but the verse names five together, so honour on dress alone is incomplete. It is not the ONLY quality — there are five. वस्त्र IS

among the five, so honouring it is not entirely wrong. And dress is a virtue, not one of the six faults.

**44. (A)** Refined speech is a virtue while anger is a fault; harsh angry speech sacrifices the virtue to the fault. Speech is not itself a fault — it is one of the five va-qualities. Anger is condemned, never a virtue. And वाणी (speech) and क्रोधः (anger) are entirely different words and meanings.

**45. (C)** Respect comes from the five qualities and prosperity from shedding the six faults — a both/and program. Wealth-plus-sleep ignores the qualities and indulges a fault. The verses demand both cultivation and shedding, not a choice between them. And anger/procrastination are faults to shed, not a recipe to follow.

**46. (B)** Filling the pot is the gradual-gain verse; purity ruined by a lie invokes the purification verse, where the mind is cleaned by truth. The va-qualities and faults verses are not about gradual gain or truth-cleaning. The title and inner-enemy verses do not cover drop-by-drop filling. And दीर्घायुष् (long life) is unrelated to either idea here.

**47. (B)** The verses mix cases: नरः and दोषाः are nominative while the means/agent (वकारैः, इच्छता) are instrumental, so the cases are not uniform. They are not all instrumental, nor all nominative. And the faults verse plainly contains nouns (दोषाः, भूतिम्), so 'no nouns' is wrong.

**48. (A)** The four means are water, truth, austerity and knowledge (ज्ञान); विद्या is a honouring quality, not a listed purification means. Water, truth and austerity are all genuine means. (The intellect's means is ज्ञानेन, not विद्या.)

**49. (C)** वाणी (speech) is a honouring va-quality, so it is the intruder among faults. Drowsiness, fear and procrastination are all genuine members of the six faults.

**50. (C)** The honouring list uses विद्या; the purification verse uses ज्ञान for the intellect, so the overlap the friend claims does not exist. विद्या is not literally repeated in the purification verse. विद्या does not clean the body (water does). And विद्या does appear — as a honouring quality — so 'neither verse' is wrong.

**51. (A)** क्रमशः denotes a steady, drop-by-drop progression from start to finish, not a sudden surge at the end. It does not mark a sudden moment. It is the opposite of 'all at once'. And it means gradual forward filling, not emptying or going backwards.

**52. (D)** The drop-pot principle says small repeated inputs build to a large whole — so daily small lies grow into a big bad habit. Claiming they never accumulate denies the verse's core. The image is explicitly extended beyond water to abstract growth. And drops add up rather than cancel out.

**53. (B)** All three claims are wrong: five qualities not six, mind cleaned by truth not water, and दीर्घसूत्रता is procrastination not long life. So it is not just one error. 'Mind by water' IS an error (the body, not the mind, is cleaned by water), so it is not two. And it is certainly not error-free.

**54. (A)** Five qualities, six faults, intellect by knowledge, body by water — all correct. The first wrong option flips both counts and the intellect's means. The second swaps the body/intellect means. The third swaps the mind's and soul's means (mind needs truth, soul needs austerity).

**55. (B)** 'नित्यम्' (daily) + 'पिबामः' (drink in) urges a daily habit of absorbing wisdom, dovetailing with the drop-pot's gradual accumulation. 'Once in a lifetime' contradicts 'daily'. The 'drink' is figurative absorption of wisdom, not literal water. And last-minute memorising is the very procrastination the chapter condemns.

**56. (D)** Qualities earn respect, but the second verse ties prosperity to SHEDDING the faults, so unshed faults still threaten prosperity. Qualities do not automatically cancel faults. Nor do two faults erase genuine qualities entirely. And the chapter treats faults as decidedly relevant, not ignorable.

**57. (A)** वपुस् prizes a sound body, but निद्रा and तन्द्रा are faults — virtue lies in mastering the body, not surrendering to sleep. The body is not itself a fault (वपुस् is rightly a quality). Sleep is listed among faults, not virtues. And वपुस् (body) and निद्रा (sleep) are distinct.

**58. (A)** The chapter joins cultivating qualities, shedding faults, gradual effort, and right-means-for-each-goal into one philosophy. It explicitly rejects instant results and one-size-fits-all methods. It locates the chief obstacle (laziness) WITHIN, not outside. And it condemns sleep, comfort and delay while affirming that effort matters.

**59. (C)** A gerundive expresses what OUGHT to be done, so हातव्याः = 'must be given up'. It is not a finished past act ('were given up'). It is not an action in progress ('are being given up'). And it carries obligation to abandon, not future praise.

**60. (D)** सुभाषितरसम् is what is drunk — the object of पिबामः — so it takes the accusative. The drinkers ('we') are the subject carried in the verb, not this word. It is not a means (which would be instrumental). And it is not a form of address (vocative).